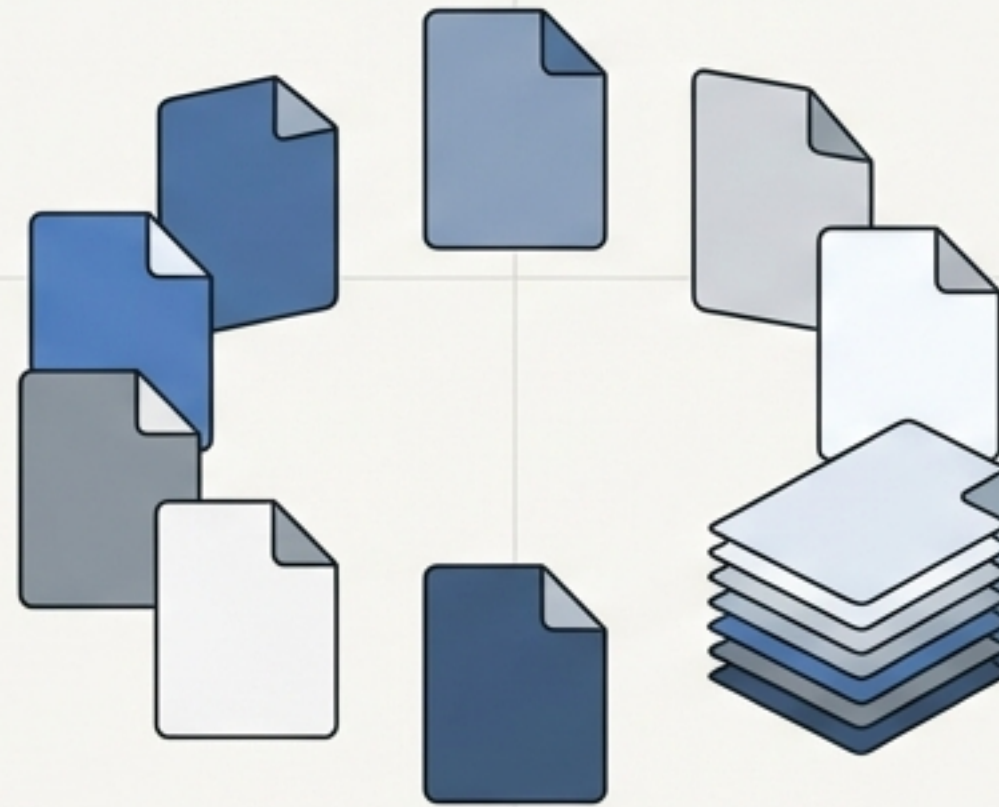


The Cursor Dev Loop

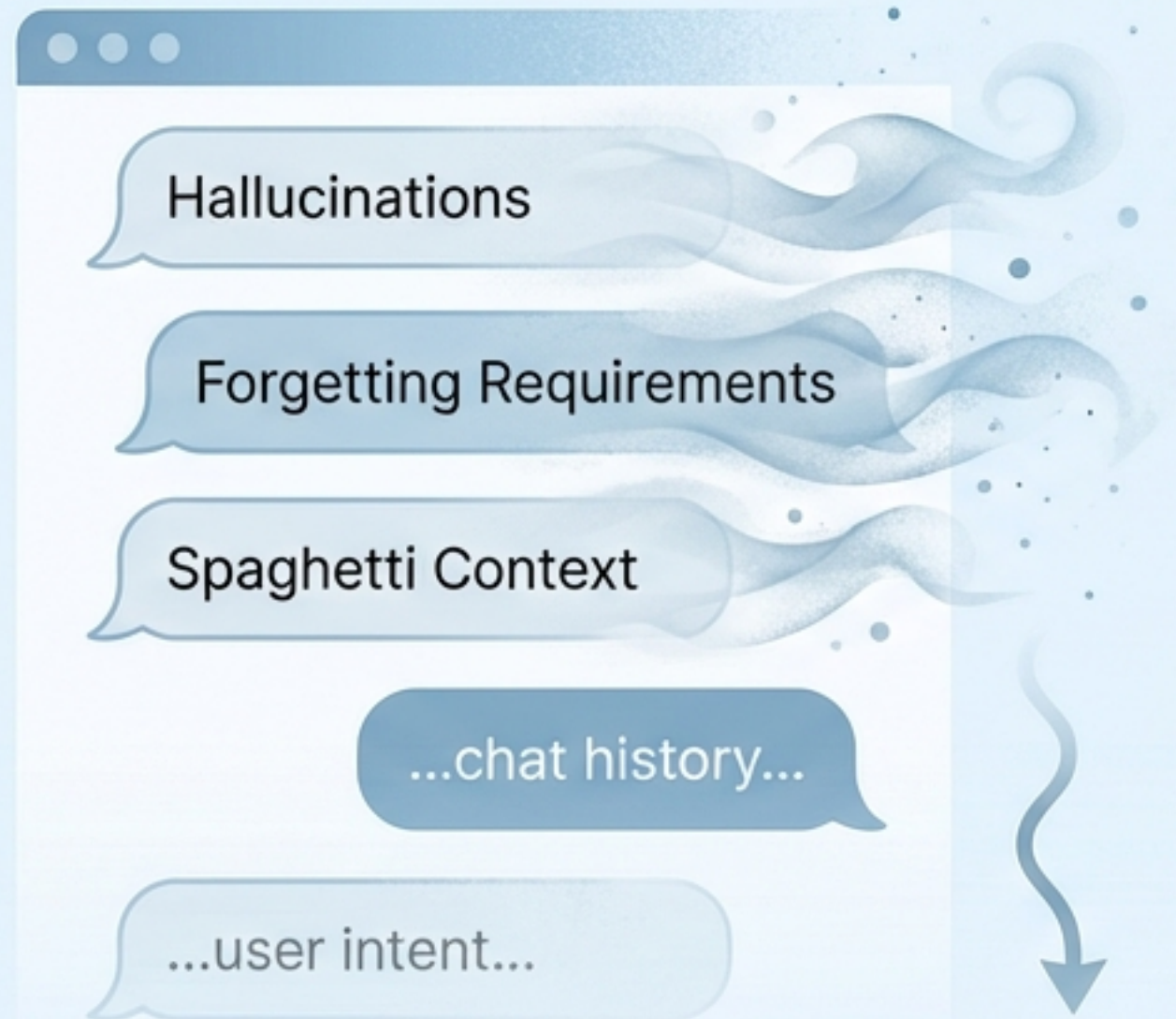
A Document-First, Rule-Guided Workflow for AI-Assisted Development



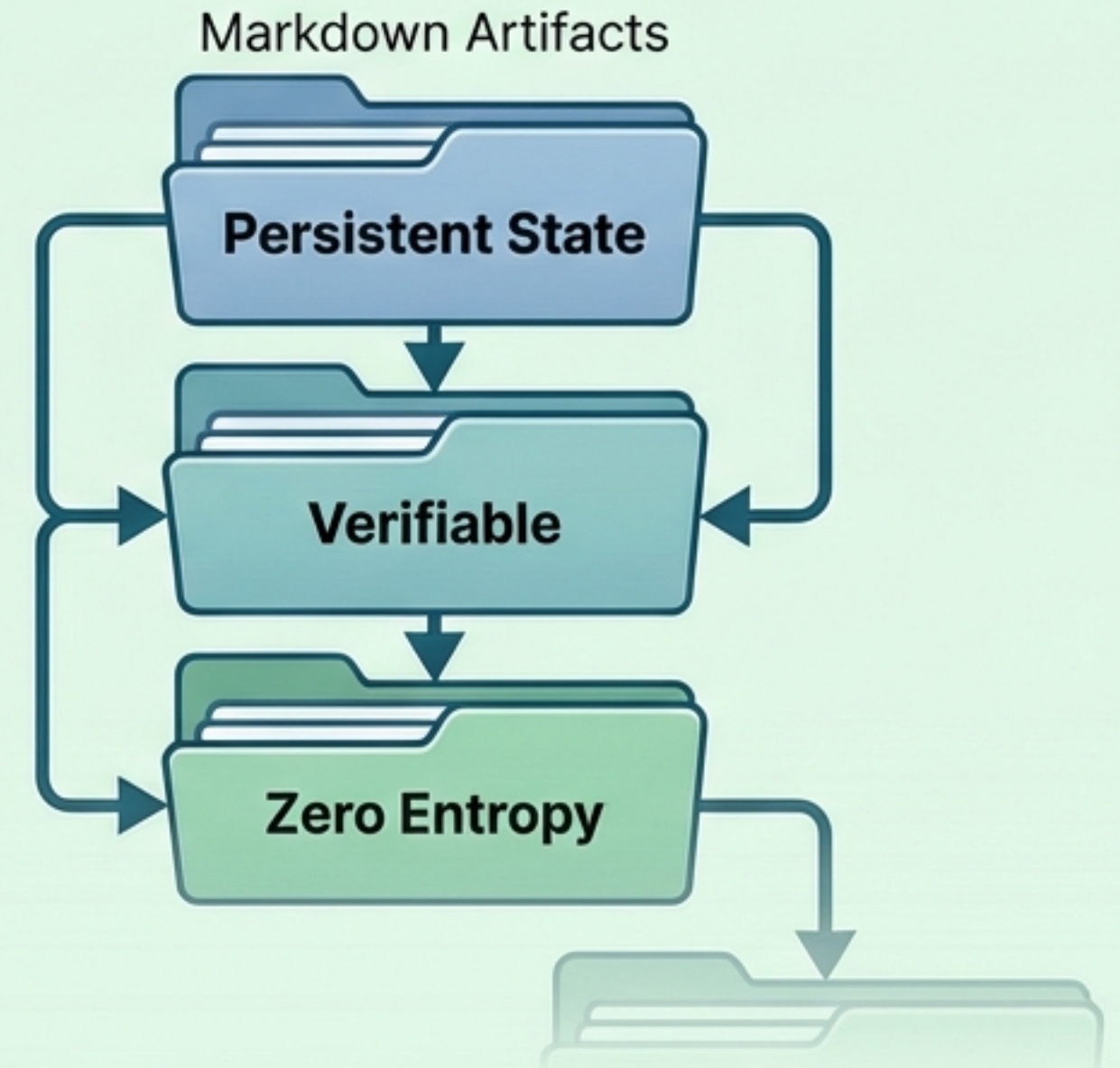
Scaling Development with Persistent Context

The Core Insight: Memory vs. State

The Context Trap



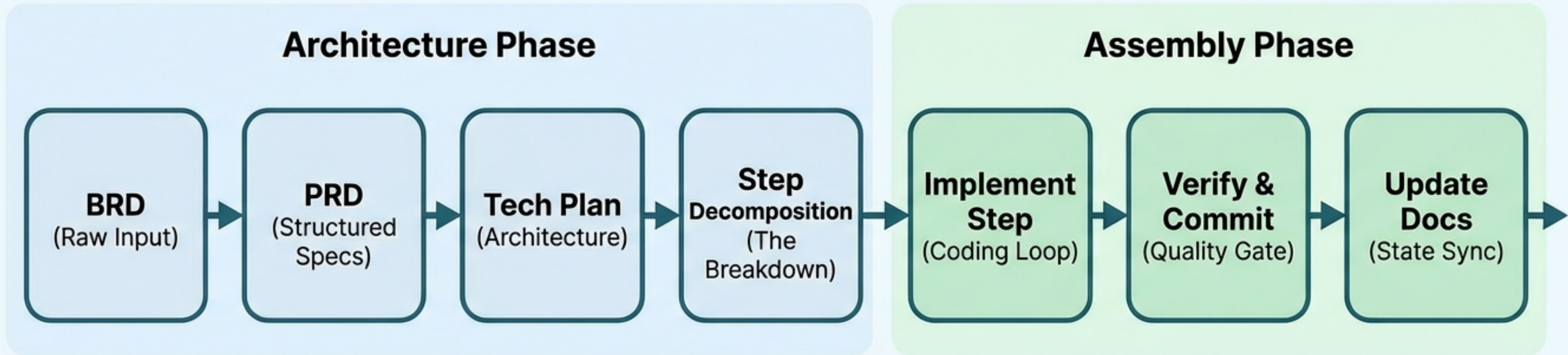
The File-Based Solution



“Plans are cheap, code is expensive.”

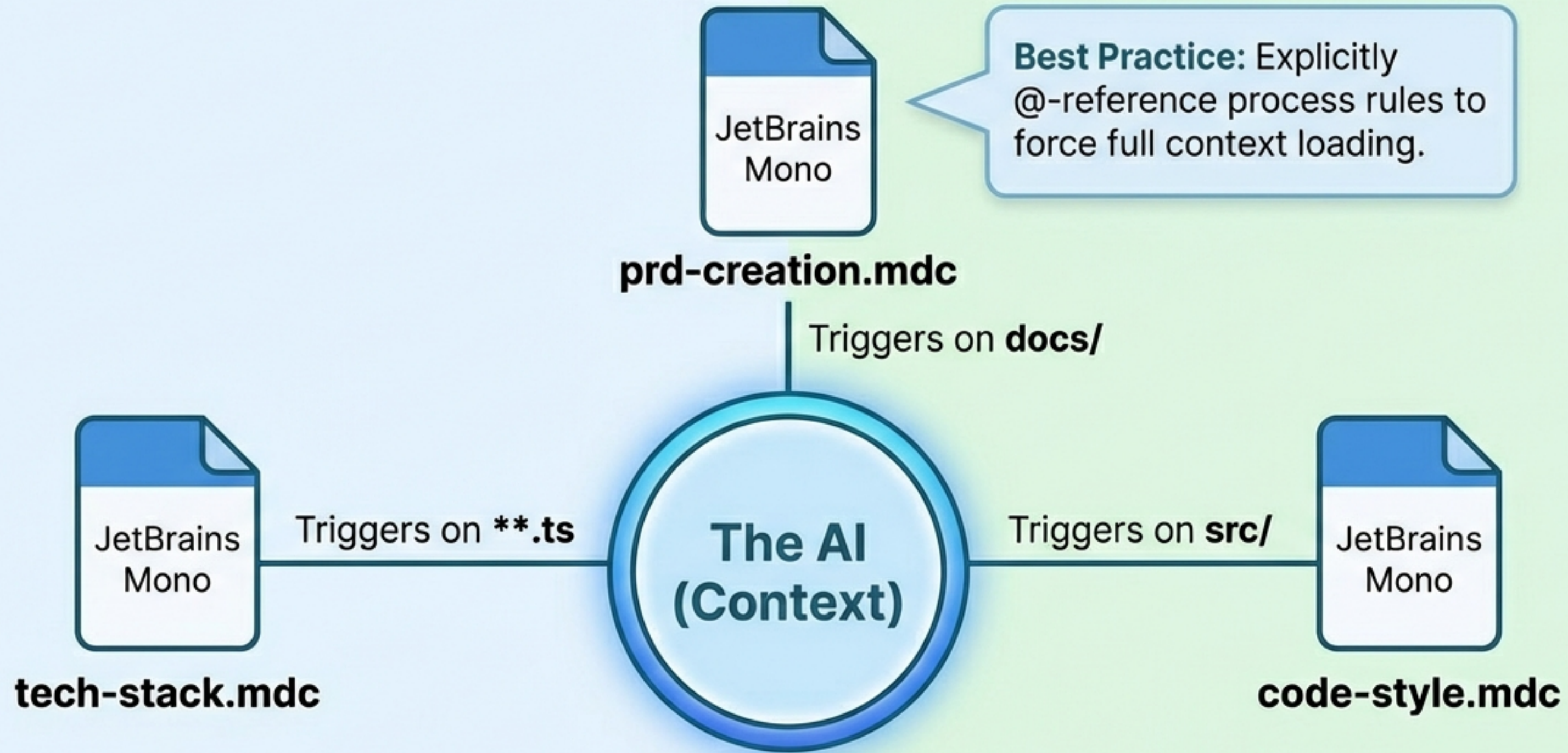
The Shift: Move from “Chatting with code” to “Document-driven assembly”.

The Workflow Engine



A predictable **pipeline where** heavy reasoning happens early, and implementation is merely assembly.

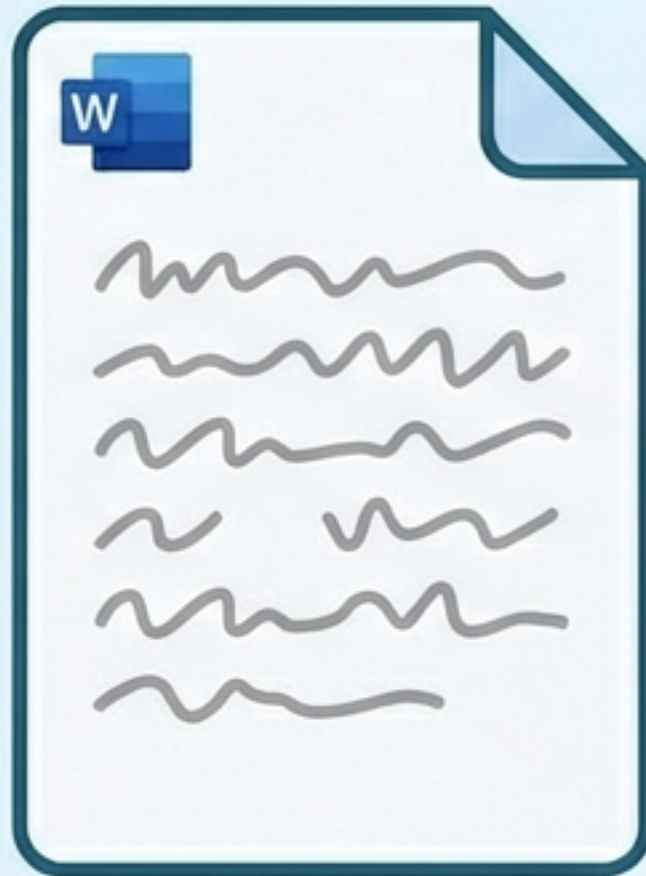
The Automation Layer: Cursor Rules (.mdc)



Rules activate **automatically** via file globs, acting as invisible guardrails.

From Rough Idea to Strict Requirements

Step 1: Ask Mode

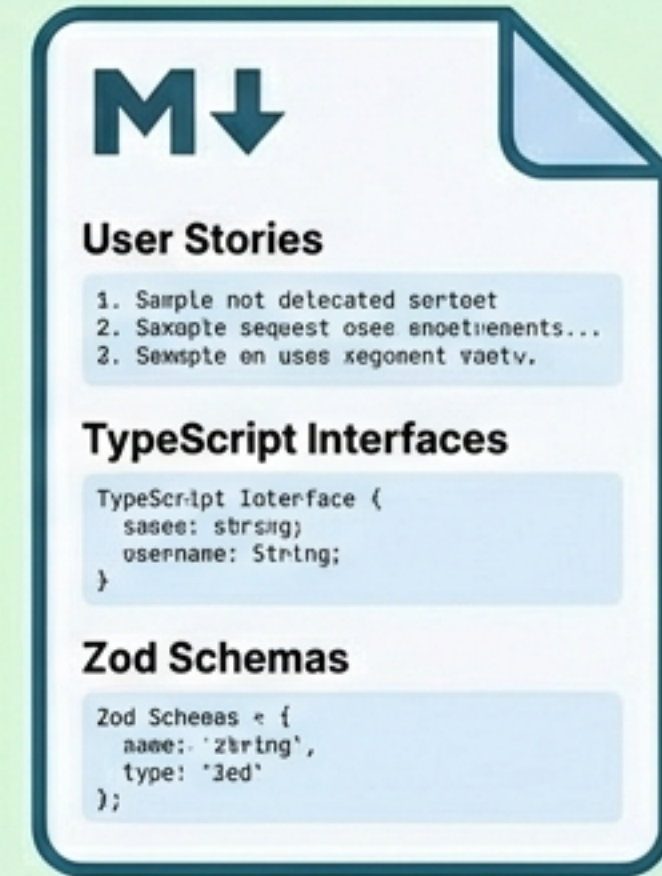


BRD (Word Doc)



Rule: prd-creation.mdc

Step 2: Agent Mode (High-Intel)

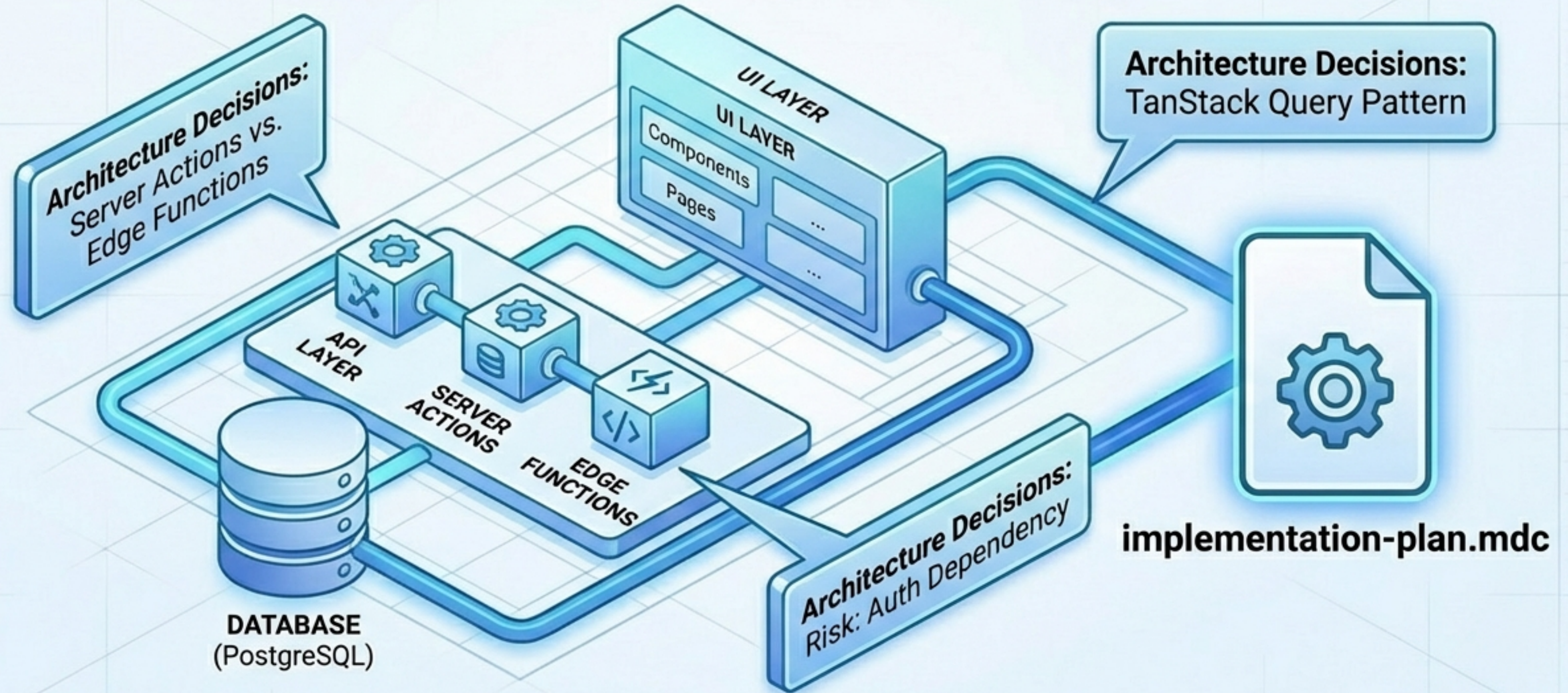


PRD (Markdown)

- ✓ Strict Types Defined
- ✓ No Ambiguity
- ✓ Ready for Code

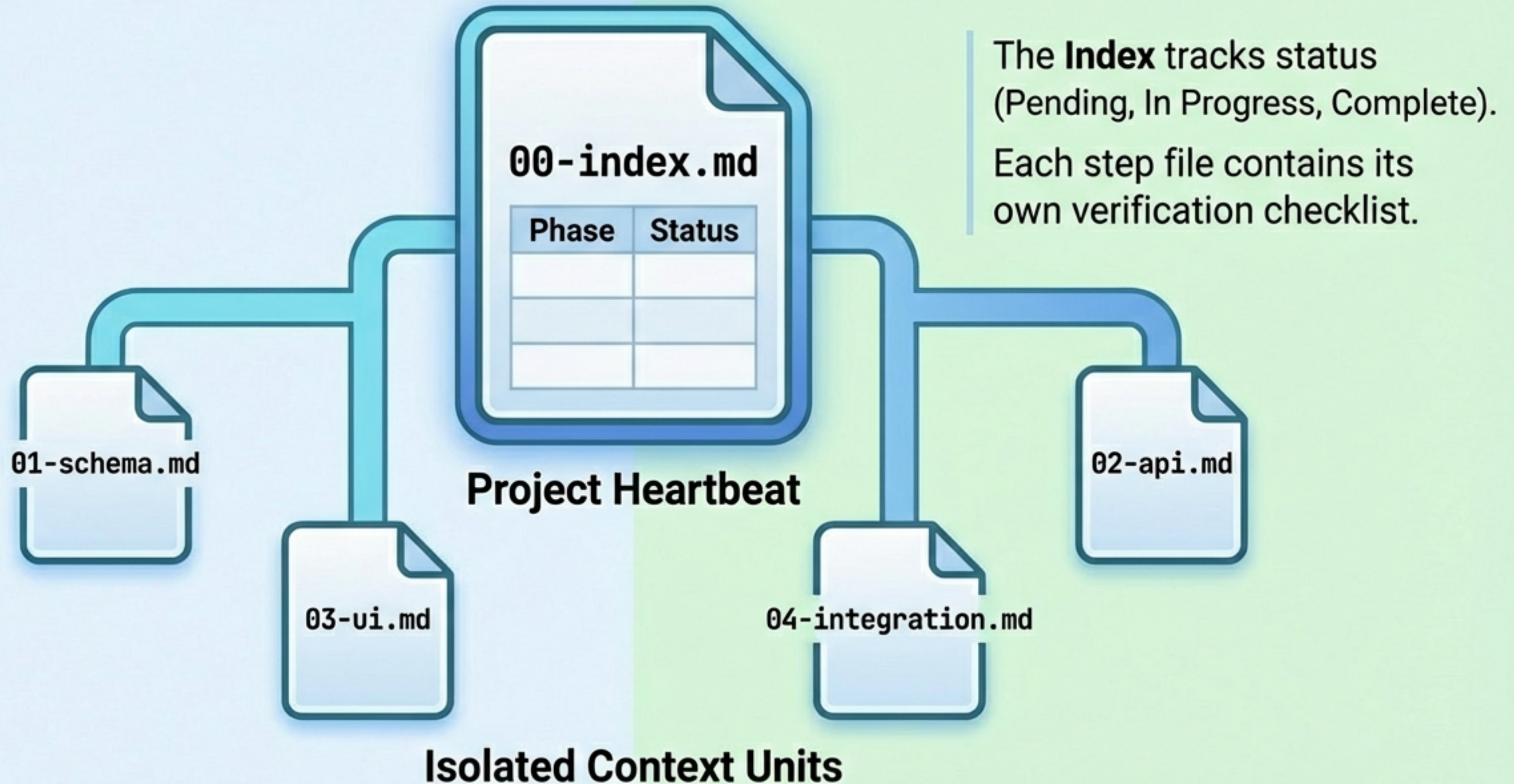
The Blueprint: Catching Mistakes While They Are Cheap

Step 3: Implementation Plan

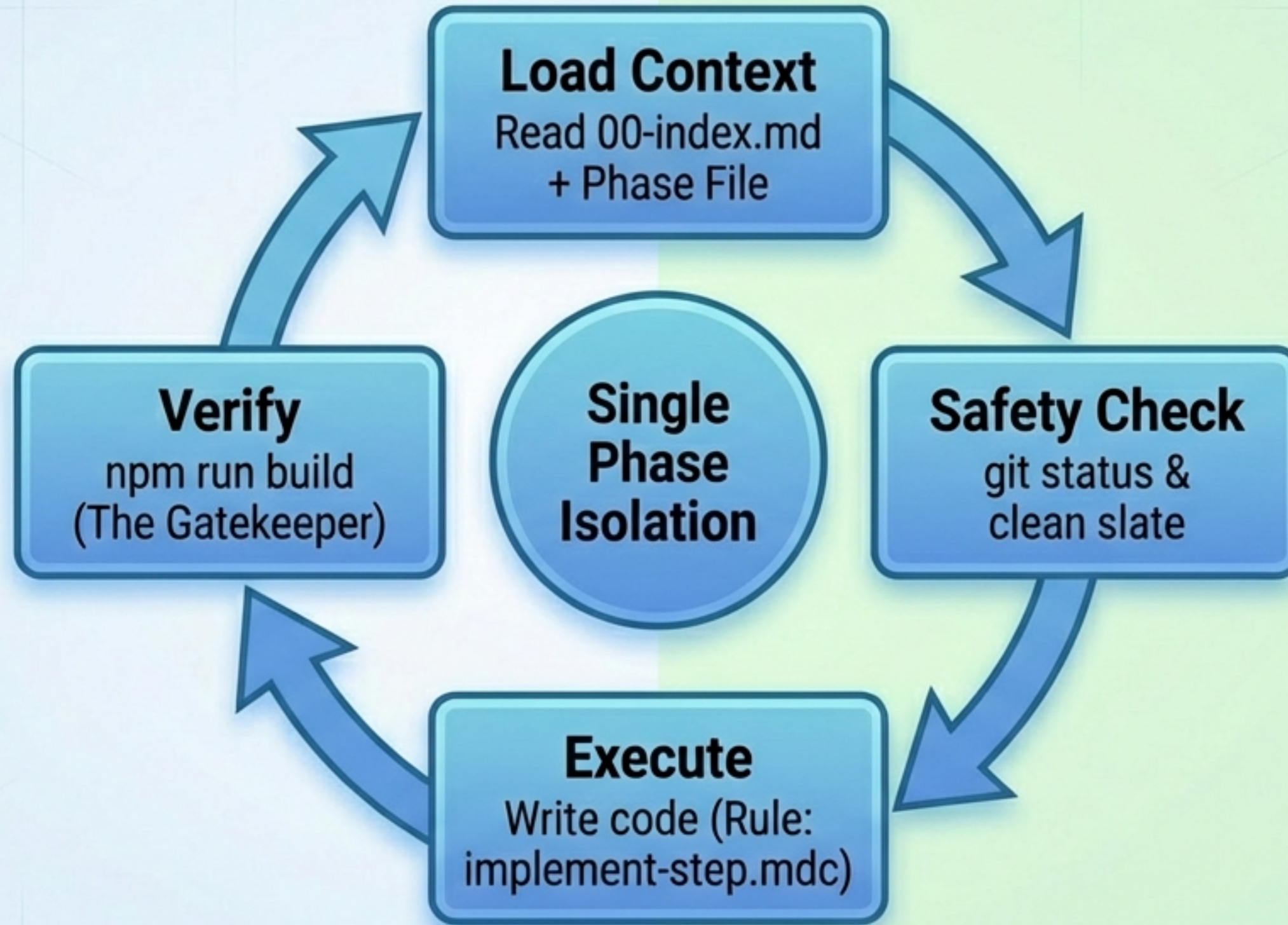


Insight: We define **HOW** we build before a single line of code is written.

The State Machine: Decomposition



The Execution Loop (Step 5)



Drag only one phase file at a time into context. Isolation of phases = Isolation of AI attention.

Dynamic Model Selection



High-Intelligence (Claude Opus/Sonnet)

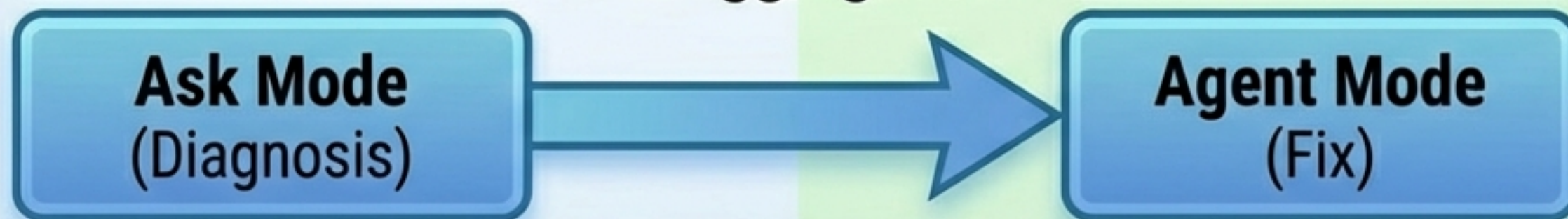
- **Use Case:** Architecture, Tricky UI, Integration
- **Reasoning:** Needs reasoning about edge cases.



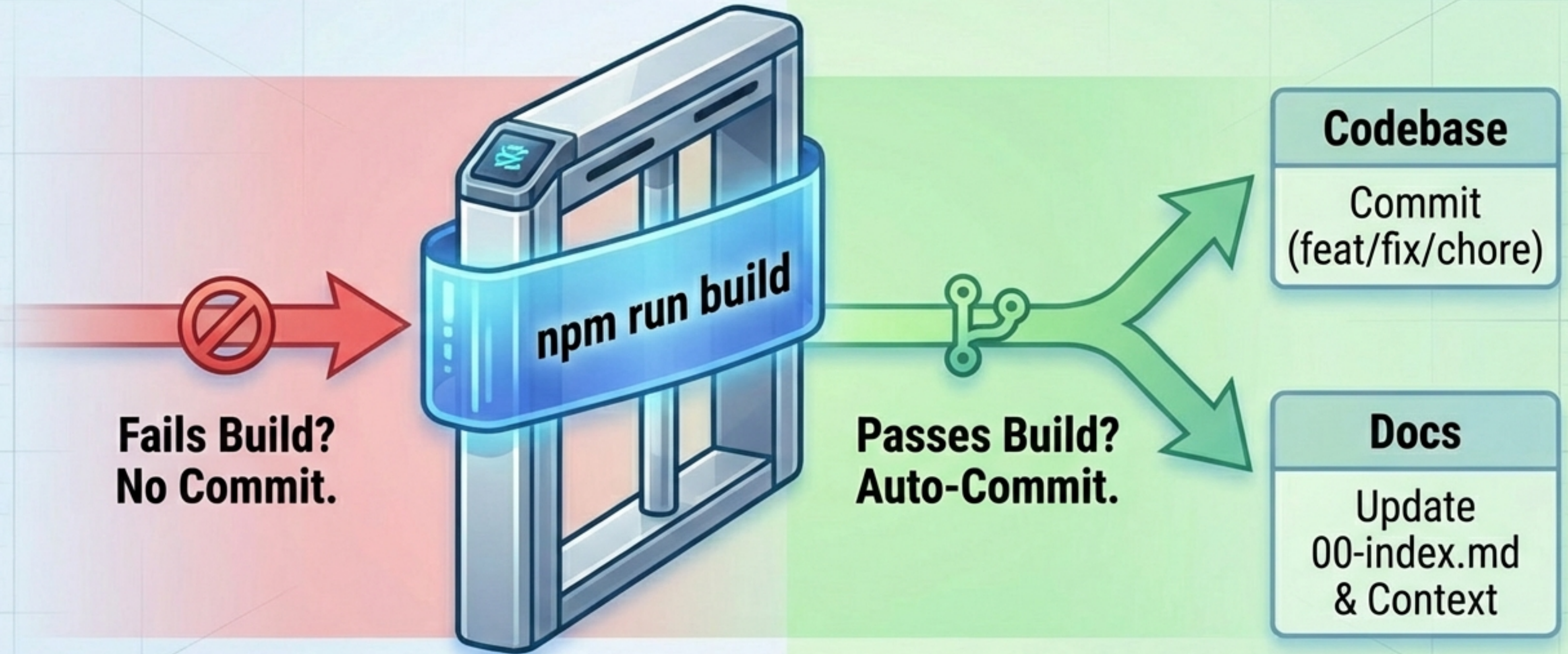
Fast/Cheaper Models

- **Use Case:** CRUD, Types, Boilerplate
- **Reasoning:** Plan defines code; implementation is just assembly.

Debugging Flow

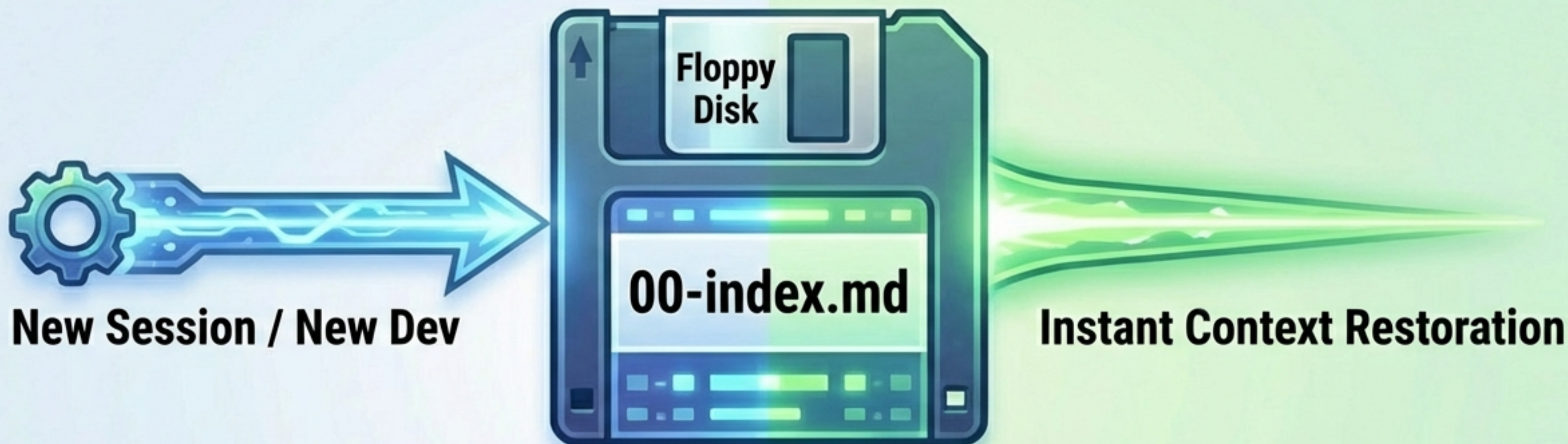


Verify, Commit, Sync



Outcome: Code and Documentation are synced at every commit hash.

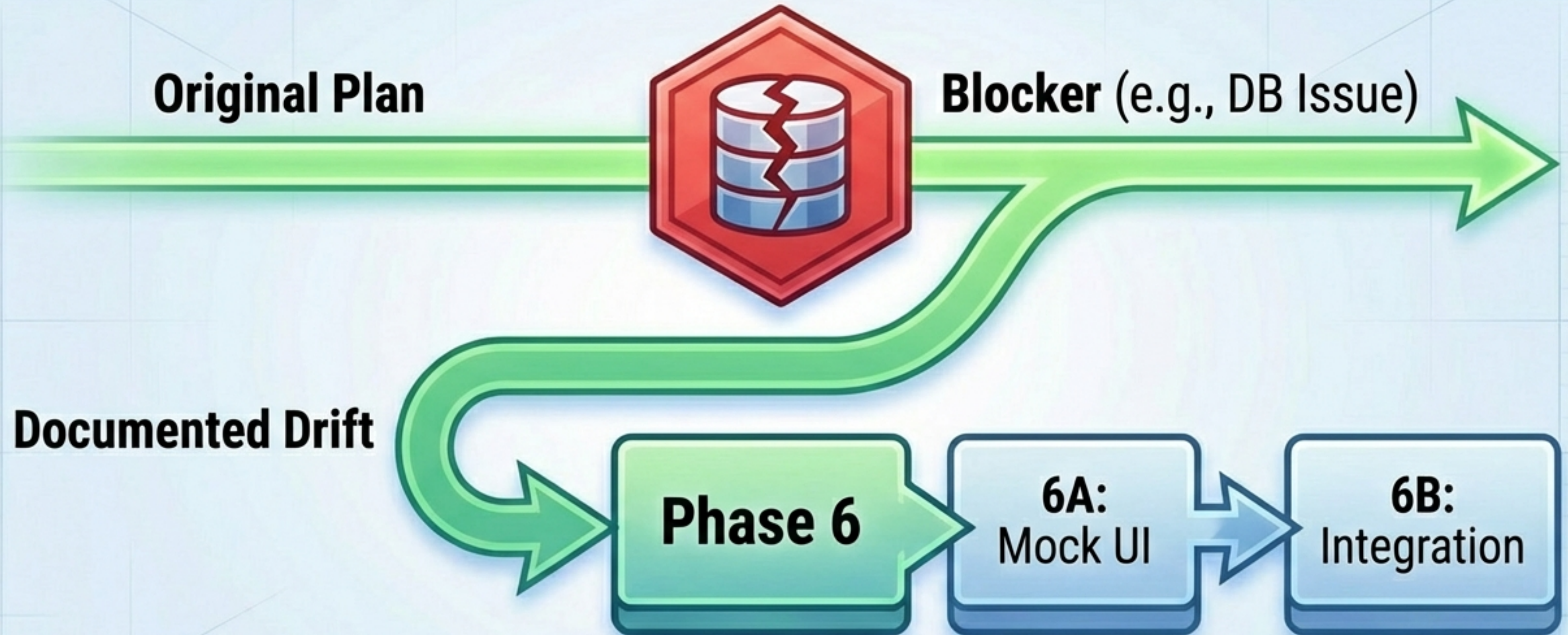
Context Recovery & Session Management



Prompt: Read `00-index.md`, find next Pending phase, run safety check.

A new developer can pick up the project instantly by reading a single file, even with zero prior knowledge.

Handling Change & Deviation

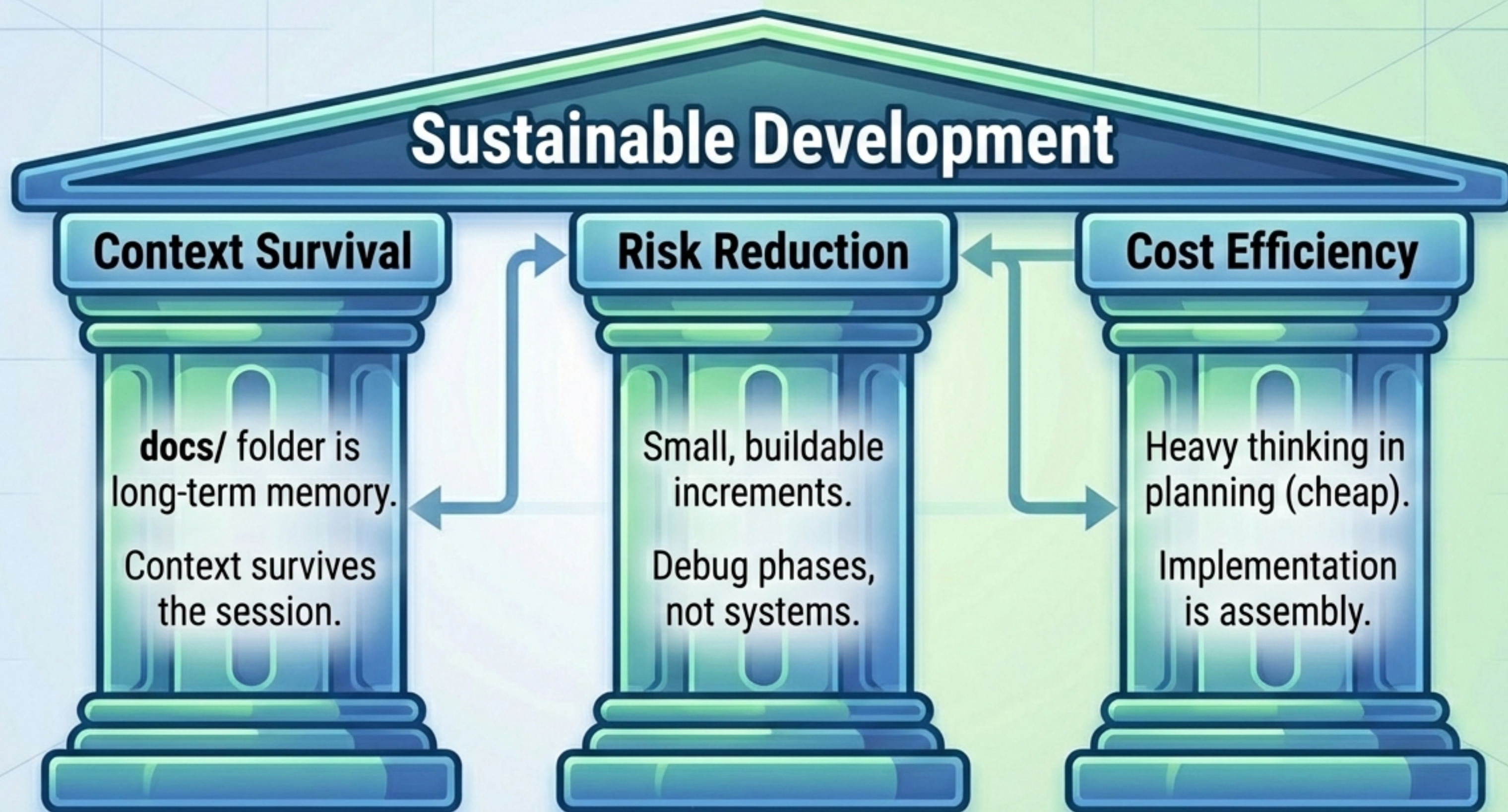


Do not silently deviate. Update the Index. Document the drift.

The Quick Reference Guide

Step	Primary Rule	Mode	Model
PRD Creation	prd-creation.mdc	Agent	High Intel
Tech Plan	implementation-plan.mdc	Agent	High Intel
Split Steps	implementation-steps.mdc	Agent	High Intel
Implement	implement-step.mdc	Agent	Context Dependent
Commit	github-workflow.mdc	Agent	Same as Implement
Update Docs	implement-step.mdc	Agent	Fast Model

Why This Works



**Stop Chatting.
Start Building.**
Adopt the **Document-First Loop.**